

Brand *platform*

Who we are, how we talk, and what to say while the name changes. For everyone at the firm.

Working draft · September 28, 2026

Internal. Not for clients.

This page is for everyone at the firm: who Casteel Financial is, how we talk, and what to say while the name changes. It's a working draft. Heidi will mark each piece as decided when it is, and positioning is still being worked out from the client data. The thinking behind all of this, and what's still open, is kept in Heidi's working notes.

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At a glance

Who we are	An independent, fee-only financial planning and investment firm in Waynesburg. Same people and same office; the name becomes Casteel Financial on January 1, 2027.
Who we're for	People with a real decision in front of them, like retiring, drawing income, or passing something on. We're values-based, not occupation-based.
What we're like	Careful, plain-spoken, and personal. We look under every rock.
How we sound	Calm and direct, like a smart person at a kitchen table
What we're not	A sales shop, a luxury brand, or a template

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What to say today

When someone asks what we do: "We're an independent financial planning firm here in Waynesburg. We're fee-only, which means we're paid by our clients, not through commissions."

About the name change (for use once it's announced; draft talking points):

- Same people, same office, same accounts. Only the name is changing.
- For the first year, say "Casteel Financial, formerly Milinovich & Co."
- Why it's changing: this is personal work, and Joshua wants the name to say who the firm is today.
- Speak about the Milinovich name with respect. Some longtime clients are attached to it.
- Cypher & Cypher's move is separate news, and it's theirs to announce. We don't prepare taxes. If a client asks, we'll help them find where to go.

Full talking points and a team FAQ come before the December 18 team prep.

Say this, not that

SAY

NOT

Fee-only fiduciary, then what it means: legally required to act in your best interest

"Trusted partner"

Tax strategy, tax planning

Tax preparation (we don't prepare taxes)

Clients, families, people

"High-net-worth individuals"

Working people, people who built something

"Blue collar"

A specific detail

An adjective doing the same job

Joshuah Dains, CFP®, CMA®

"Josh," in anything written

Casteel Financial

"Casteel Wealth," or any other spelling

Words we skip: financial freedom, peace of mind, trusted partner, tailored solutions, holistic approach, and "we're different."

How we sound

We sound like a smart person talking across a kitchen table, never like a brochure. The example lines show the feel. They aren't approved copy.

WE'RE	SOUNDS LIKE	DOESN'T SOUND LIKE
Plain-spoken	"We don't earn commissions on anything we recommend."	"We deliver holistic, tailored wealth solutions."
Calm	"Markets dropped this week. Here's what it means for your plan, and what we're doing."	"Don't panic!" or anything that creates urgency
Specific	"We'll look at when to take Social Security, your pension choice, and which accounts to draw from first."	"We optimize every aspect of your retirement."
Warm	"Bring whatever you have, even if it's a shoebox. We'll sort it out together."	"Please submit all required documentation prior to your appointment."
Direct	"Fiduciary means we're legally required to act in your best interest."	Jargon left unexplained, or hedging that says nothing
Occasionally dry	"Yes, we'll explain what a Roth conversion is. No, there's no quiz."	Puns, exclamation points, or jokes about money trouble

The tone shifts with the moment:

MOMENT	TONE	FOR EXAMPLE
First impressions	Confident, specific, unhurried	"Here's how we're paid, and where your money is held."
Bad market news	Calm and early	"You'll see a lower balance this quarter. Here's what we're watching."
A death in the family	Quiet and human, never selling	"There's nothing you need to decide this week. We'll call next Tuesday."
Teaching	Clear and patient; answer first	"A Roth conversion means paying some tax now to pay less later. Here's when it can make sense."
Referral partners	Collegial and brief	"Here's who we're a good fit for, and how we'll keep you in the loop."

MOMENT	TONE	FOR EXAMPLE
Community and social	Relaxed and local	A real photo from an event we attended, with one line about who was there

The test for any line: could it run on another advisor's website unchanged? If so, rewrite it.

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Five things we never say

We're a registered investment adviser, so what we say publicly has rules. Anything that goes out to clients or the public gets reviewed first.

1. **Nothing that promises results.** No "grow your wealth," "never run out," or "retire with confidence."
2. **No guarantee, best, #1, safe, or risk-free.**
3. **No client quotes or stories without review,** even anonymous ones.
4. **No fee numbers except the official schedule,** and only once Joshua decides to publish it.
5. **Nothing that suggests we prepare taxes.** We do tax strategy.

Our story

Joshuah grew up watching his dad go to work in a hard hat and come home with a green lunch box. At night his dad sat at the kitchen table paying the bills: on time, with as little debt as possible. His parents worked hard and didn't trust the stock market. Investing felt too risky to a dad who took real risks at work every day. Joshuah's first memory of money is a whiteboard in the kitchen showing what each grade on a report card was worth. Work hard, get paid.

An uncle got him interested in investing. Joshuah liked money and he liked helping people, but he never wanted to be a financial advisor. The ones he saw in college were told to call their friends and family and sell. That wasn't for him.

Then Mike Milinovich, whom he knew from Rotary, invited him to lunch and said he'd be retiring in seven years; Joshuah should buy his business. When Joshuah started, there were no sales goals. Mike's pitch was to learn the business and take it from there. He began by answering phones, sitting in on meetings, and doing paperwork. What surprised him was how much of the work is the rest of a client's life: estate plans, tax strategy, and what happens to a family when someone dies. That part became the heart of the job.

Joshuah bought the firm in December 2025. He's changing the name because this is personal work, and he believes a firm's name should say who it is. In ten years he wants Tim and Hayley to be more successful, the firm to serve more of the community at a higher level, and the business not to depend on him alone.

Working draft. Joshuah reviews this before any of it is used publicly.

Who we are

This came through again and again on Discovery Day, in the team's own words.

- **Careful.** Joshua explains estate planning as flipping over rocks in a creek looking for crayfish. Most rocks have nothing under them, and you look under every one anyway: "not because every rock hides a problem, but because every client deserves to know someone looked."
- **Straight about money.** We're fee-only by how we're built, not as a talking point. Joshua says "fiduciary" and then says what it means.
- **Personal.** Relationships are the reason clients stay. They remember the greeting, the gifts, and the details nobody made them repeat.
- **Unpretentious.** If we were a vehicle, we'd be a Ford F-150: tough, hardworking, and it carries a lot.
- **Rooted.** Our relationships in Waynesburg took years to build: First Federal, the attorneys we work with, Rotary, and the schools.

After a meeting, clients should feel **at ease**. The model is Ritz-Carlton hospitality, where you never have to repeat yourself.

Personality (proposed, built from the Discovery Day answers). If Casteel were a person, it would be the capable neighbor who happens to be very good with money: calm, direct, a little dry, and never showing off. It looks under every rock and tells you plainly what it found.

What we're not

WE'RE NOT SO WE AVOID

A sales shop	Pitches, products up front, and pressure. Northwestern Mutual came up as the firm we'd hate to be mistaken for.
A luxury brand	Generic luxury imagery and "exclusive" language. Most clients don't think of themselves as wealthy.
Cold or staged	The "sterile plant" look the team rejected: cold, straight-lined, with staged, stock-feeling photos. A dark design isn't the problem; staged photography is.
Folksy	Farmhouse, country, and small-town cliché. Waynesburg is a strength, not a costume.
Cheap and self-serve	The "Aldi of financial advice"
A template	Navy and gold; stock photos of retirees; mountains, compasses, lighthouses, handshakes, and upward arrows; shields and crests

About "steel." The name invites it. Steel can shape the brand quietly, through structure, precision, and permanence. It never becomes literal: no steel beams, no factory look, nothing that echoes the Steelers. We don't explain it in copy.

How clients should feel

Most of the brand is what clients experience, not what they read. Joshua's standard: closer to the Ritz-Carlton than a Hampton Inn.

MOMENT	WHAT IT SHOULD FEEL LIKE
Calling or walking in	Known by name. Nobody has to repeat themselves.
Getting started	Clear about what happens next and how long it takes
The financial plan	Something made with care, not a printout
Reviews	We reach out before they have to ask.
Family meetings	The next generation gets to know us, not just the name on the door.
A hard moment	Calm, early, and personal
A gift	Useful and real, never a trinket